

Between the Lines — Paper A

MEDIUM • 35 MINUTES • 25 MARKS

NAME

DATE

SCORE / 25

- Answer **every** question in the space provided.
- Read **both** texts once, properly, before you answer anything. The last two questions need both.
- Answer only from the lines the question names. A perfect answer from the wrong lines scores nothing.
- When a question asks for **two things**, give two separate ideas. One idea written twice is one mark.
- Pay attention to punctuation and spelling. The number of marks is shown in brackets [] on the right.
- The ladder: **Says** (what happened) → **Shows** (what the writer chose to put there) → **So what** (what that implies). A question asking what something *tells* or *suggests* wants the third rung, proved with the second.
- For any explanation mark: **quote short, zoom to one word inside your quotation, then say what it suggests**. An inference with no word behind it scores the same as a blank.

Text A — Meera is twelve. Her father delivers tiffin boxes across four streets every morning; today he has a fever, and she has taken the cycle out alone for the first time.

- 3 The cycle is too big for her and always has been. Meera stands on the pedals rather
4 than sitting, and the crate of tins behind her complains at every pothole on Sampige
5 Road. Eleven tins. She counted them at the gate, and then, at the corner, she counted
6 them again.
- 7 Her father does this round in fifty minutes. He has done it for nineteen years and he
8 does not carry the list, because the list is in his head: Sharma, second floor, no
9 chilli. Fernandes, ground floor, ring twice. The Iyer boys, who will not come down
10 unless you shout.
- 11 Meera carries the list. She has it folded in her pocket and she has already taken it
12 out four times, and the folds are going soft.
- 13 The first three are easy. The fourth is a flat on the third floor with a lift that is
14 switched off until nine, and by the time she reaches the landing her arms are shaking
15 and the tin is warm against her shirt. A woman opens the door before she knocks.
- 16 ‘You are Raju’s daughter,’ the woman says. It is not a question. ‘He is ill?’
- 17 Meera nods. She has not said a word to anyone all morning and is surprised to find
18 that her voice, when she tries it, is still there.
- 19 ‘Two minutes,’ the woman says. She comes back with a steel tumbler of water, and
20 stands in the doorway while Meera drinks it, not talking, not going back inside.
- 21 ‘Tell him Mrs Kamath asked after him.’

22 On Kanakapura Lane a tin slips as she lifts the crate and lands on its side. Nothing
 23 spills — her father’s tins are packed the way he packs everything, as though someone
 24 will drop them — but the lid dents. Meera looks at it for a while. Then she turns it
 25 so the dent faces in, and carries it up.

26 She finishes in an hour and twenty. Her father is asleep when she gets back. She puts
 27 the empty crate exactly where he leaves it, wheel against the wall, and washes the
 28 tins, and puts the list back in the drawer with the folds flattened out.

Text B — That night, Meera writes in the back of her maths notebook.

30 Did the round. Did NOT die.

31 1 hour 20. Appa does it in 50. I know because he says it roughly four times a week,
 32 usually while eating.

33 Counted the tins about nine times. Nobody told me to. I just kept thinking, what if
 34 it’s ten, what if I’ve left one at the gate and someone’s kid gets no lunch.

35 Mrs Kamath (402) gave me water and just stood there watching me drink it, which was
 36 weird, and then also nice? Both. She said tell him I asked.

37 Dented one lid. Turned it round so the dent faced the wall. I’m not writing that
 38 anywhere he can see it, and I am aware that this is a notebook.

39 The thing nobody tells you is the lift is off till nine. He knows that. He knows all
 40 of it, he just doesn’t say any of it out loud, it’s all in his head and I had a piece
 41 of paper.

42 Doing it again tomorrow if he’s still ill. Not saying that to him though.

SECTION A – READING

1. Look at lines 3-12.

(a) Meera is anxious about the round before it has properly begun. Which **two** [2]
 things tell the reader this?

(b) What does the detail that her father *does not carry the list* tell the reader about [1]
 him? Tick (✓) **one** box.

He is careless about his work

He has done the round so long that it is all memorised

He cannot read his own handwriting

He does not care which tin goes where

2. Look at **lines 13-21**.

(a) Give a **three-word phrase** that shows the climb has been physically hard. [1]

(b) Give **one word** that means ‘the flat floor at the top of a flight of stairs’. [1]

3. Look at **lines 22-28**. Meera is careful to leave no sign that anything went wrong. [2]
Give **two** things she does that show this.

SECTION B – QUOTATION AND EXPLANATION

4. Look at **lines 15-21**. Which of these opinions do you agree with most? Tick (✓) **one** box, then give **two** quotations that support the opinion you chose, and explain how each one supports it.

Mrs Kamath is simply being polite to a neighbour’s child.

Mrs Kamath can see that Meera is struggling, and helps without saying so.

Quotation 1 [1]

Explanation 1 [1]

Quotation 2 [1]

Explanation 2 [1]

5. Look at **Text B (lines 30-42)**. Meera writes informally because it is a private notebook. Give **two** quotations that are examples of informal writing, and explain how each one shows informality.

An example has been given.

Quotation: *Did NOT die.*

Explanation: capital letters are used for the emphasis of speech, as if she were saying it out loud to a friend.

Quotation 1

[1]

Explanation 1

[1]

Quotation 2

[1]

Explanation 2

[1]

SECTION C – THE WHOLE TEXT

6. Look at **lines 39-41**.

(a) Give **one word** that means ‘a single part of something larger’.

[1]

(b) What does *it’s all in his head and I had a piece of paper* tell the reader about how Meera now sees her father?

[1]

7. Look at **lines 22-25**. What does *as though someone will drop them* suggest about Meera's father? Tick (✓) **one** box. [1]

He expects his daughter to be careless

He packs for the worst thing that could happen, every time

He has dropped a tin himself in the past

He does not trust the people on the round

8. Look at **Text B**. What features tell the reader that this text is a private journal rather than a story? Give **two** features. [2]

9. Look at the **whole text**.

- (a) Meera and her father both take a pride in the round that neither of them says out loud. Give **one** phrase for each that shows this. [2]

- (b) Put these events into chronological order, numbering them from first (1) to last (5). **One** example has been done for you. [3]

Event	Order of events
Meera counts the tins at the gate	1
Mrs Kamath brings a tumbler of water	
Meera writes in her maths notebook	
A tin lid is dented on Kanakapura Lane	
Meera takes out the list for the fourth time	

End of paper. Before you hand it in, check every explanation names a word from inside your own quotation. That is the mark most often left behind on a paper like this.